



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 5217

LCO No. 1407



Referred to Committee on EDUCATION

Introduced by:
(ED)

***AN ACT ESTABLISHING THE COMMISSIONER OF EDUCATION AS
THE DEPARTMENT HEAD OF THE DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION.***

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 4-5 of the general statutes is repealed and the
2 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective July 1, 2028*):

3 As used in sections 4-6, 4-7 and 4-8, the term "department head"
4 means the Secretary of the Office of Policy and Management,
5 Commissioner of Administrative Services, Commissioner of Revenue
6 Services, Banking Commissioner, Commissioner of Children and
7 Families, Commissioner of Consumer Protection, Commissioner of
8 Correction, Commissioner of Economic and Community Development,
9 [State Board of Education] Commissioner of Education, Commissioner
10 of Emergency Services and Public Protection, Commissioner of Energy
11 and Environmental Protection, Commissioner of Agriculture,
12 Commissioner of Public Health, Insurance Commissioner, Labor
13 Commissioner, Commissioner of Mental Health and Addiction
14 Services, Commissioner of Social Services, Commissioner of
15 Developmental Services, Commissioner of Motor Vehicles,

16 Commissioner of Transportation, Commissioner of Veterans Affairs,
17 Commissioner of Housing, Commissioner of Aging and Disability
18 Services, Commissioner of Early Childhood, Commissioner of Health
19 Strategy, executive director of the Office of Military Affairs, executive
20 director of the Technical Education and Career System, Chief Workforce
21 Officer and Commissioner of Higher Education. [As used in sections 4-
22 6 and 4-7, "department head" also means the Commissioner of
23 Education.]

24 Sec. 2. Section 10-3a of the general statutes is repealed and the
25 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective July 1, 2028*):

26 (a) There shall be a Department of Education. [which shall serve as
27 the administrative arm of the State Board of Education.] The department
28 shall be under the direction of the Commissioner of Education, [whose
29 appointment shall be recommended to] who shall be appointed by the
30 Governor [by the State Board of Education] for a term of four years to
31 be coterminous with the term of the Governor. Such appointment shall
32 be in accordance with the provisions of sections 4-5 to 4-7, inclusive, as
33 amended by this act. The Commissioner of Education shall be the
34 [administrative officer] department head of the department and shall
35 administer, coordinate and supervise the activities of the department.
36 [in accordance with the policies established by the board.]

37 (b) The [State Board of Education] Commissioner of Education shall
38 organize the Department of Education into such bureaus, divisions and
39 other units as may be necessary for the efficient conduct of the business
40 of the department, and may, from time to time, create, abolish, transfer
41 or consolidate within the department any bureau, division or other unit
42 as may be necessary for the efficient conduct of the business of [said
43 board] the department. Upon such organization or reorganization the
44 [board] commissioner shall adopt regulations pursuant to the
45 provisions of chapter 54. The [board] commissioner may create such
46 advisory boards as it deems necessary for the efficient conduct of the
47 business of the department.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>July 1, 2028</i>	4-5
Sec. 2	<i>July 1, 2028</i>	10-3a

Statement of Purpose:

To make the Commissioner of Education the department head of the Department of Education.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]